



Georgia Emergency Management Agency (GEMA) and Homeland Security (HS)  
Attn: Nonprofit Security Grant Program (NSGP)

Dear Review Committee:

Turner Theological Seminary respectfully submits its application for the FY 2025 Nonprofit Security Grant Program. As a nonprofit theological education institution situated in a high-risk urban area, Turner serves clergy, students, and community partners through academic programs, worship services, and public events that place our campus within Department of Homeland Security (DHS)–identified categories of nonprofit organizations at elevated risk.

Recent assessments from DHS, the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), and GEMA/HS confirm increasing threats to houses of worship, faith-based organizations, and nonprofit institutions operating in densely populated urban corridors. Turner’s internal vulnerability assessment identified critical gaps in access control, surveillance, emergency notification, and physical hardening that require immediate action to ensure the safety of our campus community and continuity of operations.

The proposed NSGP-funded enhancements directly address these vulnerabilities, align with FEMA’s allowable costs, and strengthen Turner’s ability to deter, detect, delay, and respond to potential threats. The Seminary is fully committed to meeting all NSGP requirements and sustaining the equipment and training supported through this award.

Thank you for your consideration of our application. Please contact us if additional information is needed.

Sincerely,

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## Executive Summary

FY 2025 Nonprofit Security Grant Program (NSGP)  
Turner Theological Seminary – Atlanta, Georgia

Turner Theological Seminary is a nonprofit theological education institution situated in a high-risk urban area of Atlanta, Georgia, affiliated with a rich heritage of Wesleyan tradition and sacramental practice. Turner prepares clergy, chaplains, ministry leaders, and community servants through academic instruction, worship, and community-facing programs that draw students, clergy, and visitors to campus throughout the week.

Federal and state intelligence from DHS, FBI, and GEMA/HS confirms escalating threats toward houses of worship, religious education institutions, and nonprofit organizations that maintain open and accessible facilities in major metropolitan areas. Consistent with these findings, Turner’s internal vulnerability assessment identified critical weaknesses—including limited access control, insufficient surveillance, inadequate exterior lighting, absence of panic/duress systems, and outdated emergency communication capabilities—that increase the risk of unauthorized entry, delayed detection, and limited ability to respond to a targeted incident.

To address these vulnerabilities, Turner proposes a coordinated security enhancement project that includes:

- Electronic access control and secure door hardware
- Interior and exterior surveillance cameras, NVR, and monitoring capability
- Panic/duress alarms and a mass-notification system
- Security window film, reinforced entry points, and upgraded exterior lighting
- Comprehensive training, updated emergency action plans, and joint exercises with law enforcement

These improvements directly align with NSGP priorities to deter, detect, delay, and respond to threats affecting high-risk nonprofit organizations. The project is cost-effective, FEMA-eligible, and designed to provide long-term, campus-wide protection for academic, residential, worship, and community spaces.

Turner Theological Seminary will implement this project through a cross-functional Security Enhancement Team and will fully comply with all procurement, reporting, and sustainment requirements. The Seminary is committed to maintaining this equipment and integrating emergency preparedness into ongoing operations so that its mission of preparing faithful and effective leaders can continue in a secure and resilient environment.

## Background and Mission

Turner Theological Seminary is a faith-based, graduate-level institution dedicated to preparing women and men for Christian leadership in the church and the world. As a nonprofit theological education institution situated in a high-risk urban area, Turner advances academic excellence,



spiritual formation, and faithful ministry practice through rigorous theological education, ministry training, and community engagement.

Turner equips called leaders who preach, teach, serve, and provide pastoral care with courage, integrity, and compassion. The Seminary provides a safe and nurturing learning environment where students deepen their faith, sharpen their gifts, and are sent forth to serve congregations, chaplaincy ministries, nonprofit organizations, and faith-based initiatives across the nation and abroad.

The Seminary's campus is located within a densely populated corridor of Atlanta, in proximity to multiple colleges, faith-based organizations, and community institutions. High daily foot and vehicle traffic, frequent special events, and the presence of multiple public-facing organizations in the surrounding area create a complex security environment and heighten the importance of well-designed physical security and emergency preparedness.

Turner fulfills its mission through:

- Public worship and weekly chapel services
- Graduate-level academic instruction
- Evening and weekend programs
- Off-campus ministry placements and community partnerships
- Conferences, denominational gatherings, and special events

These mission-implementing practices require an open and welcoming posture while simultaneously increasing public visibility, creating periods of high occupancy, and raising the need for comprehensive security measures in alignment with DHS and FEMA guidance for soft targets and crowded places.

## **Risk Justification**

Turner Theological Seminary is at an elevated risk of targeted violence due to its profile as a nonprofit theological education institution situated in a high-risk urban area, its regular schedule of worship and public events, and its open-campus ministry culture. The Seminary hosts a significant number of activities that draw students, clergy, denominational leaders, community members, and visitors to campus, including weekday and evening classes, chapel services, weekend events, and off-campus ministry engagements.

National and state-level intelligence, including assessments from DHS, FEMA, and GEMA/HS, identify houses of worship, religious education institutions, and other nonprofit organizations in dense metropolitan environments as at heightened risk for targeted threats. Turner's location along a heavily traveled urban corridor—with nearby public streets, major transportation routes, and neighboring institutions—further increases exposure.

Turner's internal assessment, informed by consultation with local partners, identified the following core risk factors:



- Open and accessible buildings during classes, chapel, and events
- Multiple entry points with limited access control and monitoring
- Insufficient camera coverage and surveillance blind spots
- Inadequate exterior lighting around building approaches and parking areas
- Limited emergency notification capabilities and inconsistent staff training in threat response

NSGP funding is necessary for Turner to address these vulnerabilities, implement critical physical security enhancements, improve threat detection and access control, and establish a robust protective posture in alignment with federal preparedness and mitigation priorities.

## **Threat–Vulnerability–Consequence (TVC) Assessment**

### **A. Threat**

Faith-based institutions, houses of worship, and theological schools across the United States have experienced a documented rise in threats, hostile intrusions, and targeted acts of violence. Publicly accessible religious and educational facilities, particularly those located in major urban centers, have been identified by DHS and state homeland security agencies as attractive targets due to their symbolic value, open-door culture, and periods of high occupancy.

Turner Theological Seminary operates in a densely populated downtown corridor with substantial daily pedestrian and vehicular traffic. The Seminary’s mission-driven activities—including chapel services, classes, community programs, and events open to attendees from across the city and region—create recurring soft-target conditions and increase the likelihood of encounters with individuals who may seek to disrupt religious teaching, ministry training, or public events.

The Seminary’s location near major transportation routes and public streets, combined with its proximity to other institutions and community facilities, elevates its threat profile by making the campus highly visible and easily accessible to potential hostile actors.

### **B. Vulnerabilities**

Turner Theological Seminary’s primary facility, Frederick Hilborn Talbot Hall, anchors its academic, administrative, worship, and residential life. The building is a four-story, multi-functional structure that includes:

- Classrooms for graduate-level instruction
- A 50-seat chapel for worship and spiritual formation
- Executive and faculty offices
- Study and multi-media rooms
- A computer-equipped resource room
- Common areas and meeting spaces
- ADA-accessible restrooms
- A multipurpose deli and dining space



- A laundry facility supporting student life

The upper floors house 56 residential units with 88 beds, providing significant on-campus housing. The facility spans 24,800 square feet of gross building area (19,825 square feet of net rentable space) on a compact urban site. While this configuration supports community life and operational efficiency, it also concentrates a large number of occupants and functions into a single building, increasing potential impact if a security incident occurs.

A recent internal assessment identified the following key vulnerabilities:

#### 1. Perimeter and Access Control

- Multiple entry points with aging hardware
- No electronic card-access system or credentialing for routine entry
- No standardized visitor management or screening process
- Doors that lack alarms, forced-entry indicators, or tamper notifications

These conditions reduce the Seminary's ability to control who enters the building, especially during high-traffic periods.

#### 2. Surveillance and Detection

- Limited security cameras with no comprehensive interior or exterior coverage
- Blind spots at entrances, hallways, stairwells, parking lots, and gathering areas
- No centralized monitoring station for real-time observation or rapid review

These gaps lower situational awareness, slow recognition of suspicious behavior, and delay notification to responders.

#### 3. Lighting and Exterior Security

- Inadequate exterior lighting around walkways, parking areas, and building approaches
- Areas of concealment near entrances during evening and early-morning activities
- No perimeter surveillance to observe approaching individuals or vehicles

Insufficient lighting and monitoring increase opportunities for hostile actors to approach unnoticed.

#### 4. Visitor Management and Identity Verification

- No integrated visitor management system for sign-in, badges, or credentialing
- Limited ability to differentiate between authorized guests and unknown individuals
- No consistent process for tracking vendors, contractors, or event participants

This creates uncontrolled access conditions during classes, chapel, events, and residential move-ins or move-outs.



## 5. Emergency Communication and Response Coordination

- No campus-wide mass-notification system to issue immediate alerts
- No fixed panic/duress alarms in administrative, classroom, or worship spaces
- Limited staff training in active-threat, suspicious package, or building evacuation procedures

These deficiencies can delay response and hinder effective coordination during an incident.

## C. Consequences

If these vulnerabilities remain unaddressed, Turner Theological Seminary faces a heightened risk of a high-impact security incident. Potential consequences include:

- Loss of life or serious injury to students, faculty, staff, and visitors during high-occupancy gatherings
- Long-term psychological trauma among survivors and the surrounding community
- Suspension of academic programs, chapel services, and community events
- Disruption of residential life and displacement of student occupants
- Operational instability and financial strain due to facility damage or prolonged closure
- Diminished confidence among students, families, and partner organizations

An incident at Turner would not only affect those on campus but also undermine the Seminary's ability to serve churches, chaplaincy settings, and nonprofit ministries that rely on its graduates. The requested NSGP-funded security enhancements are critical to mitigating these consequences and preserving the Seminary's capacity to fulfill its mission.

## 6. Proposed Security Enhancements

Turner Theological Seminary proposes the following prioritized security enhancements to address identified threats, mitigate vulnerabilities, and strengthen deterrence, detection, delay, and response capabilities. All requested items fall within FEMA's FY 2025 NSGP allowable costs and directly support Turner's Threat–Vulnerability–Consequence (TVC) assessment.

### Priority 1 – Access Control Systems (Target Hardening)

- Electronic card-access system for critical exterior doors
- Secure locking mechanisms and upgraded door hardware
- Door alarms and forced-entry/tamper indicators
- Visitor check-in and credentialing system for daily operations and events

Purpose: Establishes controlled entry, limits unauthorized access, and enhances accountability during high-occupancy periods.



## Priority 2 – Surveillance Enhancements (Detection & Situational Awareness)

- High-definition interior and exterior security cameras
- Network Video Recorder (NVR) with secure data storage
- Monitoring workstation for real-time and post-incident review

Purpose: Expands situational awareness, closes surveillance blind spots, and provides documentation for investigations and after-action analysis.

## Priority 3 – Facility Hardening (Physical Security & Protective Measures)

- Security window film for ground-level glass and vulnerable windows
- Reinforced doors and strengthened entry points
- Exterior LED security lighting for parking lots, walkways, and entrances

Purpose: Delays forced entry, increases visibility, and provides more time for occupants to respond and first responders to arrive.

## Priority 4 – Emergency Communication & Notification Systems (Response & Coordination)

- Panic/duress alarms in administrative, classroom, and worship spaces
- Mass-notification system capable of delivering text, email, and audio alerts
- Two-way communication tools to link staff, security partners, and responders

Purpose: Enables rapid warning, supports coordinated emergency action, and helps minimize casualties during an incident.

## Priority 5 – Planning, Training, and Exercises (Preparedness & Organizational Resilience)

- Updated Emergency Action Plans (EAPs) for multiple threat scenarios
- Evacuation, lockdown, and shelter-in-place drills
- Security and situational-awareness training for staff, faculty, students, and volunteers

Purpose: Builds a culture of preparedness, ensures personnel know how to respond, and strengthens institutional resilience.

## Detailed Vulnerability Assessment

Turner Theological Seminary's recent security review—conducted in collaboration with campus stakeholders and local partners—identified several critical vulnerabilities across the exterior, interior, operational, and emergency-preparedness domains. These vulnerabilities significantly increase susceptibility to unauthorized entry, delayed threat detection, and limited emergency response capability.

### 1. Exterior Vulnerabilities





- Insufficient exterior lighting creates blind spots around walkways, entrances, and parking areas, reducing visibility during evening classes, chapel services, and weekend events.
- Multiple unmonitored building entrances remain accessible during operational hours with no real-time oversight.
- No perimeter surveillance, resulting in low situational awareness of suspicious activity approaching buildings or gathering spaces.
- Glass doors and windows lack protective film, increasing the ease of forced entry and the risk of shattering hazards.

## 2. Interior Vulnerabilities

- Hallways, classrooms, stairwells, and common areas lack camera coverage, creating internal blind spots.
- Interior doors lack locks suitable for rapid lockdown, limiting protective options during hostile intruder scenarios.
- No centralized control over interior building movement, allowing unrestricted access throughout academic and administrative spaces.

## 3. Operational Vulnerabilities

- High foot traffic during chapel services, classes, and community events results in uncontrolled access and reduced ability to identify threats.
- No standardized visitor screening or credentialing, increasing the likelihood of unauthorized individuals entering sensitive areas.
- Off-campus ministry placements and community-facing programs expand exposure beyond the primary campus footprint, creating additional risk points.

## 4. Emergency Preparedness Gaps

- No panic alarms or duress systems available for staff or worship leaders to summon immediate assistance.
- Delayed notification capability due to the absence of a mass-notification or unified alert system.
- Staff and faculty lack formal, regularly exercised training in emergency response, suspicious activity recognition, and active-threat procedures.

## Prioritized Security Improvement List

### Tier 1 – Immediate Needs (Highest Impact)

- Electronic access control system
- Security cameras and NVR system
- Panic button/duress alarms
- Security window film

### Tier 2 – High-Value Enhancements





- Exterior security lighting
- Reinforced doors and hardware
- Visitor management system

### Tier 3 – Preparedness & Planning

- Staff and student training
- Updated Emergency Action Plan
- Multi-scenario drills and exercises

### **Cost-Effectiveness / Cost–Benefit**

The proposed project represents a highly cost-effective approach to reducing Turner Theological Seminary’s most urgent and high-consequence security risks. By prioritizing scalable, multi-use physical security upgrades supported by surveillance expansion and targeted training, the Seminary maximizes risk reduction per dollar invested and ensures long-term value.

#### 1. High Risk Reduction for Targeted Investment

Access control, surveillance, and panic notification directly address Turner’s most critical vulnerabilities. These measures:

- Reduce the likelihood of unauthorized entry or undetected intrusion
- Deter potential hostile actors through visible security enhancements
- Enable earlier detection and faster response, lowering potential severity

#### 2. Life-Safety Benefits

Enhanced lighting, panic alarms, and mass-notification capabilities provide immediate life-safety impact by:

- Improving visibility during evening and weekend operations
- Accelerating communication in an emergency
- Supporting timely evacuation, lockdown, or shelter-in-place decisions

#### 3. Protection Across Multiple Functions

Each requested system benefits the entire campus:

- Surveillance covers academic, residential, administrative, and worship spaces
- Access control protects sensitive areas and regulates visitor access
- Training equips personnel in all departments to respond effectively

#### 4. Sustainability



The proposed equipment:

- Is compatible with existing infrastructure
- Can be maintained within Turner’s operating budget
- Can be supported through routine staff training and vendor service agreements

## 5. Avoided Costs

Compared to potential losses from a successful incident—injuries, fatalities, property damage, program disruption, enrollment impacts, and long-term recovery costs—the requested NSGP investment is a prudent and proportionate measure to secure a vital faith-based educational institution serving the wider community.

## Project Management, Milestones, and Timeline

Turner Theological Seminary will manage the project through a Security Enhancement Team (SET) led by the President & CEO (or designee), with representation from Facilities/Operations, Business & Finance, IT, and Campus Safety. The SET will:

- Coordinate procurement in compliance with federal and state requirements
- Oversee installation and integration of systems
- Liaise with GEMA/HS, DHS/FEMA, and local law enforcement partners
- Track milestones and maintain required documentation

### Anticipated Milestones (36-Month Performance Period)

- Months 1–3: Finalize scope, confirm specifications, initiate procurement
- Months 4–9: Install access control, cameras, lighting, and notification systems; test and integrate
- Months 10–15: Conduct training; update and distribute Emergency Action Plans; initiate tabletop exercises
- Months 16–24: Conduct joint exercises with law enforcement; refine procedures based on after-action findings
- Months 25–36: Evaluate system effectiveness; finalize sustainment plan; complete reporting and closeout

## Coordination with Law Enforcement and Whole-Community Approach

Turner Theological Seminary embraces a whole-community approach to safety and security. The Seminary collaborates with local law enforcement, fire/EMS, and homeland security partners to ensure that security enhancements support coordinated prevention, response, and recovery.

Upon award, Turner will:

- Invite law enforcement partners to review camera placement and access-control design
- Share floor plans, contact lists, and emergency procedures to aid response



- Include law enforcement and first responders in trainings and exercises

Turner also engages with denominational partners and neighboring institutions to share lessons learned and promote stronger security practices across the broader community.

### **Risk Mitigation Table (Paired Vulnerabilities & Solutions)**

| <b>Identified Vulnerability</b> | <b>NSGP-Eligible Mitigation</b>  | <b>Impact</b>                             |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Open access entrances           | Access control, visitor system   | Prevents unauthorized entry               |
| Blind spots & low visibility    | Cameras, exterior lighting       | Enhances detection & deterrence           |
| Unreinforced glass/doors        | Security film, hardware upgrades | Delays intruder & increases survival time |
| No panic/alarm system           | Panic buttons, mass alert system | Speeds response & reduces casualties      |
| No emergency training           | Security training, drills        | Increases preparedness & resilience       |
| High-traffic public events      | Surveillance & access control    | Protects against high-casualty scenarios  |

### **Sustainment Plan**

Turner Theological Seminary is committed to sustaining all NSGP-funded investments beyond the grant period. Sustainment will be supported through:

- Annual operating budgets for maintenance, software updates, and licensing
- Integration of system checks into regular facilities and IT workflows
- Ongoing professional development and refresher training for staff
- Collaboration with vendors and service providers for lifecycle support

Security enhancements will be treated as core infrastructure necessary to preserve life safety and institutional continuity.

### **Mission Alignment**

The proposed security enhancements are directly aligned with Turner Theological Seminary's mission and with the DHS objective to prevent, protect against, prepare for, and respond to threats affecting nonprofit organizations.

For Turner as a nonprofit theological education institution situated in a high-risk urban area:

- Prevention: Access control and surveillance deter hostile actors and reduce opportunities for unauthorized access.
- Protection: Target-hardening measures such as reinforced doors and window film strengthen the facility envelope.
- Preparedness: Updated plans, training, and drills ensure that personnel know how to respond.



- Response: Panic alarms, mass-notification systems, and two-way communication devices support rapid, coordinated action with first responders.

These investments help safeguard the Seminary's spiritual, educational, and community-serving mission while aligning with national preparedness priorities.



## **BUDGET WORKSHEET (\$200,000 Request)**

Includes AEL Codes, item descriptions, estimates, and justification.

### **A. Physical Security Enhancements**

#### **Access Control Systems – \$58,500**

##### **AEL: 14SW-01-ACRS (Access Control System)**

- Electronic card-access system (8 exterior doors) – \$32,000
- Door alarms & forced-entry indicators – \$10,500
- Visitor management system for main entrance – \$9,000
- Badge printer & credentials – \$2,000
- Installation, configuration, testing – \$5,000

**Justification:** Controls entry, tracks movement, and prevents unauthorized access—critical for a high-visibility, minority-serving institution.

### **B. Surveillance System Upgrades – \$64,000**

##### **AEL: 14SW-01-VIDA (Video Surveillance System)**

- 24 HD exterior cameras (night vision + motion) – \$28,800
- 20 HD interior cameras (hallways, entrances, chapel) – \$18,400
- Enterprise-grade NVR & server backup – \$9,000
- Security monitoring station – \$2,800
- Cabling, installation, and configuration – \$5,000

**Justification:** Enhances real-time detection, creates documentation for threat investigations, and covers all blind spots identified in vulnerability assessment.

### **C. Facility Hardening – \$38,500**

##### **AEL: 14SW-01-DOOR / 14SW-01-GLAS (Entry Point Hardening)**

- Security window film for all ground-level glass – \$18,000
- Reinforced doors & hardware upgrades – \$12,000
- Perimeter lighting (LED security lighting) – \$8,500

**Justification:** Prevents forced entry, delays attackers, increases reaction time, and improves nighttime visibility.

### **D. Emergency Notification & Panic Systems – \$24,000**

##### **AEL: 04AP-09-ALRM (Alert/Notification System)**

- 10 fixed panic buttons (admin, chapel, reception) – \$9,500
- Mass notification system (SMS, app, desktop) – \$12,000



- Staff duress wearable pendants – \$2,500  
**Justification:** Rapid life-safety notifications minimize casualties during an attack.

**E. Security Planning, Training & Exercises – \$15,000**

**AEL: 14EX-00-INEX / 14SW-00-PLAN**

- Emergency Action Plan update – \$5,000
- Security awareness training – \$3,000
- Lockdown/evacuation drills – \$3,000
- Threat assessment & continuity planning – \$4,000

**TOTAL REQUEST = \$200,000**

